

How This Deck Works

Universal Design for Learning · Multi-Tiered System of Supports

EVERY LEARNER · SAME FIRM GOAL

Multiple ways in

Every lesson opens with a real question and a clear “I can” goal, so you know why it matters and where you’re headed.

Multiple ways to see it

Direct instruction, primary sources, maps, and bilingual key vocabulary — the same ideas shown more than one way.

Multiple ways to show it

Model-with-me, sentence frames, and choices in how you respond — you reach the same goal by the route that works for you.

*Your teacher checks your progress along the way and gives you another path if you need one — **the goal never lowers.***

US.19

Causes of American Imperialism

TN STANDARD

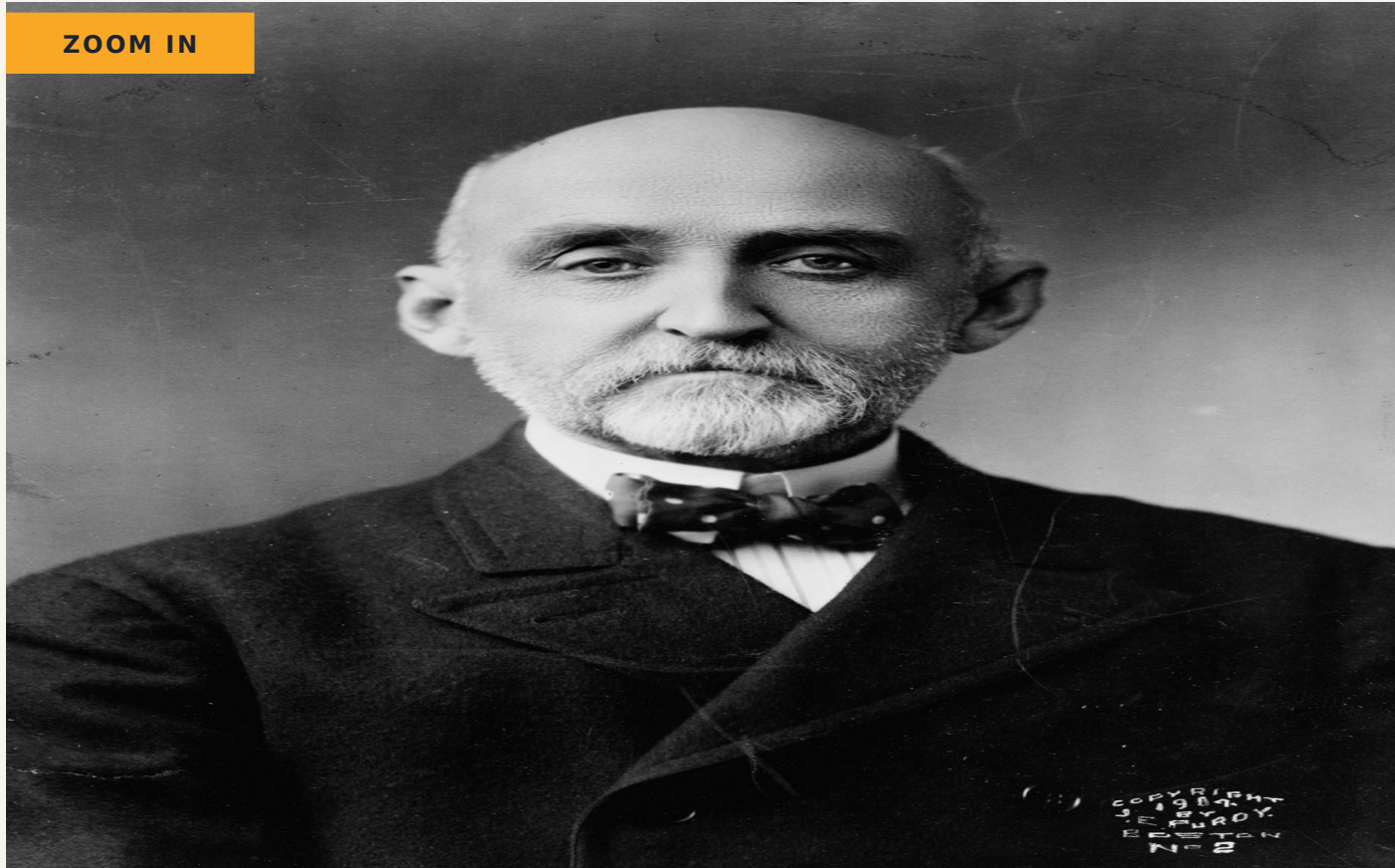
US.19 – Assess the causes of American imperialism in the late 19th and early 20th centuries, including: the desire for raw materials and new markets, the desire to spread American democratic and moral ideals, and yellow journalism.

I CAN

I can assess the causes of American imperialism in the late 19th and early 20th centuries, including the desire for raw materials and new markets, the desire to spread American democratic and moral ideals, and yellow journalism.

Economic hunger drove expansion — industry needed raw materials, overseas markets for surplus goods, and naval coaling stations to compete with Europe.

ZOOM IN



Ideology justified it — Manifest Destiny, Social Darwinism, missionary duty, and belief in American superiority framed empire as a duty to “civilize.”

ZOOM IN



Yellow journalism sold it — Hearst and Pulitzer used sensational headlines and exaggerated Spanish atrocities to push public opinion toward aggressive foreign policy.



Read Queen Liliuokalani's protest against annexation — weigh her authority and purpose before you read her words.

WHO

Queen Liliuokalani

WHEN

June 17, 1897

WHY

Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Queen Liliuokalani's Protest to the Annexation of Hawaii

Queen Liliuokalani · June 17, 1897

"I, Liliuokalani, by the Grace of God and under the Constitution of the Hawaiian Kingdom, Queen, do hereby solemnly protest against any and all acts done against myself and the constitutional Government of the Hawaiian Kingdom... Because the official protests made by me on the seventeenth day of January, 1893, to the so-called Provisional Government was not combatted with armed forces, and because said Provisional Government has been combatted with armed forces, I yield my authority until such time as the Government of the United States shall... undo the action of its representatives and reinstate me in the authority which I claim as the constitutional sovereign of the Hawaiian Islands."

[National Archives](#)

A historian returns to three questions at the end of every reading. Use them to analyze this standard.

Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.19:

American industrialists, investors, and expansionists who gained new markets, raw materials, and strategic naval bases abroad.

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.19:

Native peoples like the Hawaiians under Queen Liliuokalani, whose sovereignty was overturned so the U.S. could annex their lands.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.19:

Expansionist thinkers (Mahan), sensational publishers (Hearst, Pulitzer), and policymakers who translated economic and ideological pressure into empire.

Anchor: Queen Liliuokalani, Protest to the Annexation of Hawaii, 1897 (National Archives)

Words you need before we read

Imperialism

En español: *Imperialismo*

WHAT IT MEANS

A policy in which a stronger nation extends its economic, political, or military control over a weaker territory or nation.

Yellow Journalism

En español: *Periodismo Amarillo*

WHAT IT MEANS

Sensationalist newspaper reporting that exaggerates or fabricates stories to increase sales and influence public opinion.

Alfred Thayer Mahan

En español: *Alfred Thayer Mahan*

WHAT IT MEANS

U.S. naval officer and historian whose book "The Influence of Sea Power upon History" (1890) argued that national greatness depended on naval power, influencing American imperialism.

Check your understanding

Analyze how economic, moral, and media factors combined to create support for American expansion overseas.

- A** Economic interests created motivation, moral justifications provided legitimacy, and yellow journalism built popular support—together creating an irresistible push for imperialism
- B** Only one factor mattered; the others were irrelevant, despite the fact that multiple sources contradict this view, but the historical evidence paints a more nuanced picture
- C** These factors worked against each other, although this overlooks critical economic and social factors, but contemporary accounts and primary sources suggest otherwise
- D** Public opinion was never important for imperial policy, despite limited evidence supporting this interpretation, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😄 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.

US.20 Interventionists vs Non-Interventionists

TN STANDARD

US.20 – Compare and contrast the arguments of interventionists and non-interventionists of the period.

I CAN

I can compare and contrast the arguments of interventionists and non-interventionists of the period.

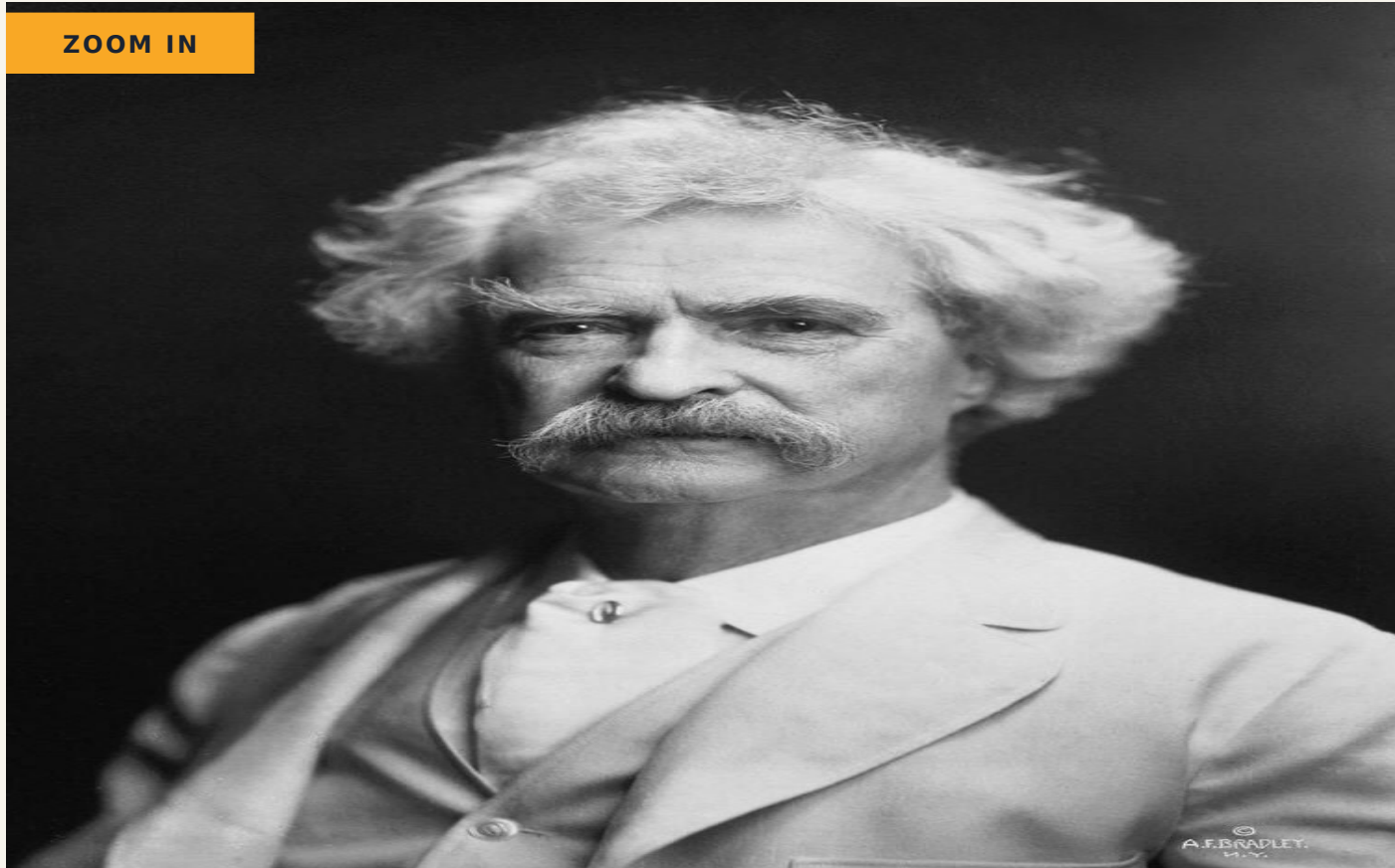
Interventionists argued for empire — Roosevelt, Lodge, and Mahan said the U.S. needed markets, naval bases, and a duty to spread democracy or fall behind Europe.

ZOOM IN



Non-interventionists pushed back — Bryan, Carnegie, and Mark Twain warned imperialism betrayed self-government and consent of the governed.

ZOOM IN



The debate split three ways — politically (power vs. limited government), economically (markets vs. costs), and morally (civilizing mission vs. self-determination).

ZOOM IN



Read Senator Hoar's anti-imperialist argument — note who he speaks for and what principle he defends.

WHO

Senator George Frisbie Hoar

WHEN

January 9, 1899

WHY

Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Speech Against Philippine Annexation

Senator George Frisbie Hoar · January 9, 1899

"You have no right at the cannon's mouth to impose on an unwilling people your Declaration of Independence and your Constitution and your notions of freedom and notions of what is good... If you undertake to govern without their consent, you may count upon resistance. The Malays are not fools. The inhabitants of the Philippine Islands are intelligent and warlike people."

[U.S. Senate Historical Office](#)

A historian returns to three questions at the end of every reading. Use them to analyze this standard.

Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.20:

Interventionists and industries positioned to profit from overseas markets, naval expansion, and new colonial possessions.

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.20:

Peoples subjected to American rule without their consent — the very self-determination anti-imperialists like Hoar and Twain defended.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.20:

Congress, the President, and public opinion — shaped by interventionists (Lodge, Beveridge) and the Anti-Imperialist League opposing them.

Anchor: George Frisbie Hoar, Anti-Imperialist Senate speech, 1902 (Library of Congress)

Words you need before we read

Imperialism

En español: *Imperialismo*

WHAT IT MEANS

A policy in which a stronger nation extends its economic, political, or military control over a weaker territory or nation.

Yellow Journalism

En español: *Periodismo Amarillo*

WHAT IT MEANS

Sensationalist newspaper reporting that exaggerates or fabricates stories to increase sales and influence public opinion.

Alfred Thayer Mahan

En español: *Alfred Thayer Mahan*

WHAT IT MEANS

U.S. naval officer and historian whose book "The Influence of Sea Power upon History" (1890) argued that national greatness depended on naval power, influencing American imperialism.

Check your understanding

Compare the political, economic, and moral factors that divided interventionists and non-interventionists.

- A** Both sides agreed on all major points, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence
- B** Interventionists emphasized global power projection, economic opportunity, and civilizing mission while non-interventionists stressed limited government, costs, and self-determination
- C** Only economic factors created disagreement, but this fails to account for the broader historical context despite the fact that multiple contemporary sources contradict this
- D** Moral arguments were identical on both sides, although historical sources do not support this conclusion when examined alongside the available primary and secondary sources

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😄 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.

US.21

Spanish-American War & Imperialism Outcomes

TN STANDARD

US.21 – Describe the causes of the Spanish-American War and the outcomes of American imperialism, including: Annexation of Hawaii, Philippine Insurrection, Roosevelt Corollary, Panama Canal, Access to Cuba.

I CAN

I can describe the causes of the Spanish-American War and the outcomes of American imperialism, including the annexation of Hawaii, Philippine Insurrection, Roosevelt Corollary, Panama Canal, and access to Cuba.

War came from Cuba — the 1895 rebellion, the USS Maine explosion (266 dead), the de Lôme Letter, and “Remember the Maine!” headlines pushed America into war.

ZOOM IN



America gained an empire — Hawaii was annexed and the Treaty of Paris gave the U.S. Puerto Rico, Guam, and the Philippines, where 200,000+ Filipinos died resisting.



US.21 · Territorial Outcomes of Imperialism

Cuba stayed under U.S. control — the Platt Amendment limited its sovereignty and the Roosevelt Corollary made the U.S. an “international police power” in Latin America.

ZOOM IN



At the top of the hill where they captured
San Juan. By Victor M. Smith. 1900.

Read the Treaty of Paris that ended the war — identify its parties and moment before you judge what it settled.

WHO

United States and Spain

WHEN

December 10, 1898

WHY

Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Treaty of Paris

United States and Spain · December 10, 1898

"Spain cedes to the United States the archipelago known as the Philippine Islands... Spain cedes to the United States the island of Porto Rico and other islands now under Spanish sovereignty in the West Indies, and the island of Guam in the Marianas... The United States will pay to Spain the sum of twenty million dollars within three months after the exchange of the ratifications of the present treaty."

[Avalon Project, Yale Law School](#)

A historian returns to three questions at the end of every reading. Use them to analyze this standard.

Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.21:

The United States, which gained Puerto Rico, Guam, the Philippines, a Cuban protectorate, and hemispheric dominance.

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.21:

Filipinos who lost 200,000+ lives resisting U.S. rule, and Cubans whose independence was curtailed by the Platt Amendment.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.21:

President McKinley, the U.S. Senate ratifying the Treaty of Paris, and Roosevelt extending the Monroe Doctrine through his Corollary.

Anchor: Treaty of Paris ending the Spanish-American War, 1898 (National Archives)

Words you need before we read

Spanish-American War

En español: *Guerra Hispano-Estadounidense*

WHAT IT MEANS

A 1898 conflict between the United States and Spain, sparked by Cuban independence movements and the USS Maine explosion, resulting in American acquisition of overseas territories.

Philippine Insurrection

En español: *Insurrección Filipina*

WHAT IT MEANS

A guerrilla war (1899-1902) fought by Filipino independence fighters against U.S. forces after the Spanish-American War, when Filipinos realized America intended to rule rather than liberate them.

Panama Canal

En español: *Canal de Panamá*

WHAT IT MEANS

A man-made waterway connecting the Atlantic and Pacific Oceans, built by the United States (1904-1914) after supporting Panama's independence from Colombia.

Check your understanding

Analyze whether the benefits of American imperialism outweighed the costs and controversies it created.

- A** Benefits clearly outweighed all costs, despite the fact that multiple sources contradict this view, which represents a common misconception about this historical period, although this overlooks critical economic and social factors involved
- B** There were no benefits to American imperialism, but this fails to account for the broader historical context and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era
- C** America gained strategic bases, markets, and global influence, but faced costly conflicts like the Philippine Insurrection, contradicted democratic ideals, and created lasting resentment—a complex legacy with both gains and significant moral and practical costs
- D** Imperialism had no lasting consequences, which does not align with the documented historical record, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence, which represents a common misconception about this historical period

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😄 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.

US.22

Diplomatic Policies: Big Stick, Dollar, and Moral Diplomacy

TN STANDARD

US.22 – Compare and contrast President Theodore Roosevelt's Big Stick diplomacy, President William Howard Taft's Dollar Diplomacy, and President Woodrow Wilson's Moral Diplomacy.

I CAN

I can compare and contrast President Theodore Roosevelt's Big Stick diplomacy, President Taft's Dollar Diplomacy, and President Wilson's Moral Diplomacy.

Roosevelt used the Big Stick (1901-1909) — “speak softly and carry a big stick” meant diplomacy backed by a powerful navy, the Great White Fleet, and the Roosevelt Corollary.

ZOOM IN



Taft used Dollar Diplomacy (1909-1913) — he substituted American investment and financial leverage for military force, though it often required troops anyway.

ZOOM IN

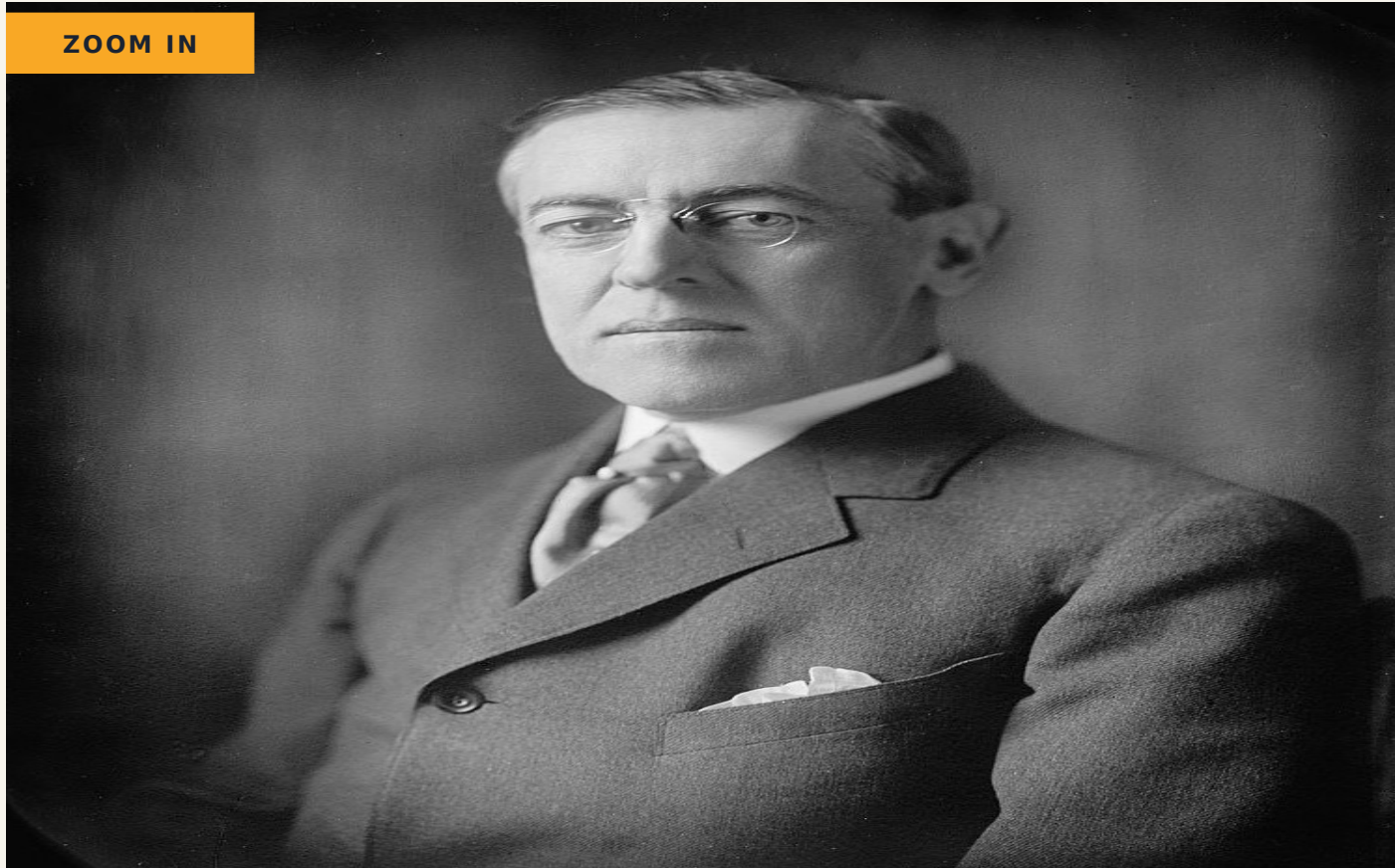


DIRECT INSTRUCTION

US.22

Wilson used Moral Diplomacy (1913-1921) — he backed only democratic governments and moral persuasion, refusing to recognize Mexico's Huerta and vowing to make the world “safe for democracy.”

ZOOM IN



US.22 · Moral Diplomacy

Read Roosevelt's Big Stick speech — fix its author, date, and purpose before analyzing it.

WHO

President Theodore Roosevelt

WHEN

1901

WHY

Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Big Stick Diplomacy Speech

President Theodore Roosevelt · 1901

"There is a homely adage which runs "Speak softly and carry a big stick; you will go far." If the American nation will speak softly and yet build and keep at a pitch of the highest training a thoroughly efficient navy, the Monroe Doctrine will go far... Right here let me make as strong a plea as I know how in favor of the Navy."

[Library of Congress](#)

A historian returns to three questions at the end of every reading. Use them to analyze this standard.

Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.22:

The United States, which expanded its global influence through power (Roosevelt), profit (Taft), and principle (Wilson).

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.22:

Latin American nations repeatedly subject to U.S. intervention under all three approaches, regardless of the method used.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.22:

Three presidents — Roosevelt, Taft, and Wilson — each defining American foreign policy through his own philosophy of power.

Anchor: Theodore Roosevelt, Big Stick / Roosevelt Corollary, 1904 (Library of Congress)

Words you need before we read

Big Stick Diplomacy

En español: *Diplomacia del Gran Garrote*

WHAT IT MEANS

Theodore Roosevelt's foreign policy approach summarized as "speak softly and carry a big stick," combining negotiation with the implicit threat of military force.

Dollar Diplomacy

En español: *Diplomacia del Dólar*

WHAT IT MEANS

President William Howard Taft's foreign policy emphasizing American business investment and loans to extend influence abroad, especially in Latin America and East Asia.

Moral Diplomacy

En español: *Diplomacia Moral*

WHAT IT MEANS

Woodrow Wilson's foreign policy rejecting imperialism and emphasizing support for democratic governments and self-determination, though often inconsistently applied.

Check your understanding

Evaluate the effectiveness of these three diplomatic approaches in advancing American interests.

- A** All three approaches were equally effective, but this fails to account for the broader historical context, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic
- B** None of the approaches achieved any goals, which does not reflect the consensus among historians, although historical sources do not support this conclusion, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence
- C** Only economic approaches were effective, which does not align with the documented historical record and oversimplifies the complex factors at work during this period, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era
- D** Big Stick Diplomacy achieved clear results through credible force, Dollar Diplomacy struggled without military backup, and Moral Diplomacy inspired but sometimes proved unrealistic—each revealed different tools of statecraft with varying effectiveness

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😄 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.

US.23

Causes of World War I & U.S. Neutrality

TN STANDARD

US.23 – Explain the causes of World War I and the reasons for the initial declaration of U.S. neutrality.

I CAN

I can explain the causes of World War I and the reasons for the initial declaration of U.S. neutrality.

MAIN causes built the powder keg — Militarism, Alliances, Imperialism, and Nationalism divided Europe into two armed camps ready to escalate any local conflict.



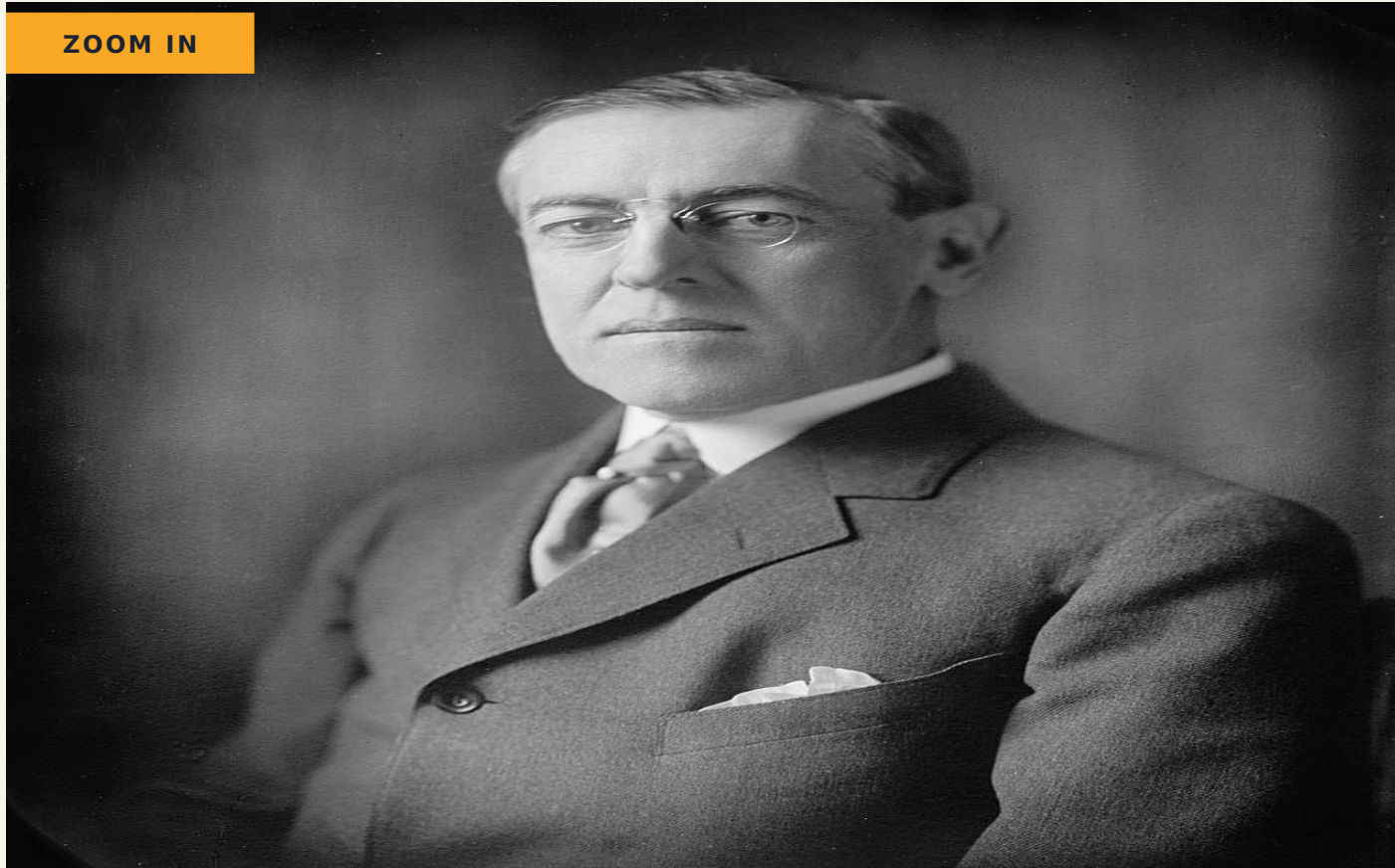
One assassination lit the fuse — the killing of Archduke Franz Ferdinand (June 28, 1914) triggered the alliance system and turned a Balkan crisis into a world war within weeks.

ZOOM IN



America stayed neutral at first — Washington's warning, divided immigrant populations, profitable trade with both sides, and Wilson's hope to mediate "peace without victory."

ZOOM IN



Read Wilson's Neutrality Proclamation — identify who issued it and why before you weigh it.

WHO

President Woodrow Wilson

WHEN

August 19, 1914

WHY

Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

U.S. Neutrality Proclamation

President Woodrow Wilson · August 19, 1914

"The United States must be neutral in fact, as well as in name, during these days that are to try men's souls. We must be impartial in thought, as well as action, must put a curb upon our sentiments, as well as upon every transaction that might be construed as a preference of one party to the struggle before another."

[Library of Congress](#)

A historian returns to three questions at the end of every reading. Use them to analyze this standard.

Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.23:

Early on, the neutral United States profited from trade with both warring sides while avoiding the fighting.

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.23:

Europe's soldiers and civilians, drawn into mass slaughter by the alliance system after a single assassination in Sarajevo.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.23:

Europe's monarchs and generals bound by alliances; and President Wilson, who chose neutrality and offered to mediate.

Anchor: Wilson, U.S. Neutrality Proclamation, 1914 (Library of Congress)

Words you need before we read

Militarism

En español: *Militarismo*

WHAT IT MEANS

The belief that a nation should maintain a strong military and be prepared to use it to defend or promote national interests; one of the M.A.I.N. causes of World War I.

Alliance System

En español: *Sistema de Alianzas*

WHAT IT MEANS

The network of mutual defense agreements among European nations before WWI, creating two opposing blocs: Triple Alliance (Germany, Austria-Hungary, Italy) and Triple Entente (France, Russia, Britain).

Archduke Franz Ferdinand

En español: *Archiduque Francisco Fernando*

WHAT IT MEANS

Heir to the Austro-Hungarian throne whose assassination in Sarajevo on June 28, 1914, by Serbian nationalist Gavrilo Princip triggered the chain of events leading to World War I.

Check your understanding

Analyze whether American neutrality was realistic given the country's economic and cultural ties to the belligerents.

- A** Despite official neutrality, American trade increasingly favored the Allies due to the British blockade, American loans went primarily to Allied nations, and cultural ties to Britain made true neutrality difficult
- B** Neutrality was easily maintained throughout the war, but contemporary accounts suggest a different explanation despite the fact that multiple contemporary sources contradict this, but contemporary accounts and primary sources suggest otherwise
- C** America had no ties to any European nation, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era, which represents a common misconception about this historical period, although this overlooks critical economic and social factors involved
- D** Economic factors were irrelevant to neutrality, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence, although historical sources do not support this conclusion despite the fact that multiple contemporary sources contradict this

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😄 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.

US.24

Reasons for American Entry into World War I

TN STANDARD

US.24 – Explain the reasons for American entry into World War I, including: the use of unrestricted submarine warfare, the Zimmerman Telegram, the defense of democracy, and economic motivations.

I CAN

I can explain the reasons for American entry into World War I, including the use of unrestricted submarine warfare, the Zimmerman Telegram, the defense of democracy, and economic motivations.

Submarine warfare killed neutrals — German U-boats sank ships without warning; the Lusitania (1915) killed 128 Americans, and unrestricted attacks resumed in 1917.

ZOOM IN FILE TO FILE

The New York Times. **EXTRA** **5:30 A. M.**

VOL. LXIV...NO. 20,523. ***** NEW YORK, SATURDAY, MAY 8, 1915.—TWENTY-FOUR PAGES. ONE CENT In Greater New York, Jersey City and Newark, TWO CENTS.

LUSITANIA SUNK BY A SUBMARINE, PROBABLY 1,260 DEAD; TWICE TORPEDOED OFF IRISH COAST; SINKS IN 15 MINUTES; CAPT. TURNER SAVED, FROHMAN AND VANDERBILT MISSING; WASHINGTON BELIEVES THAT A GRAVE CRISIS IS AT HAND

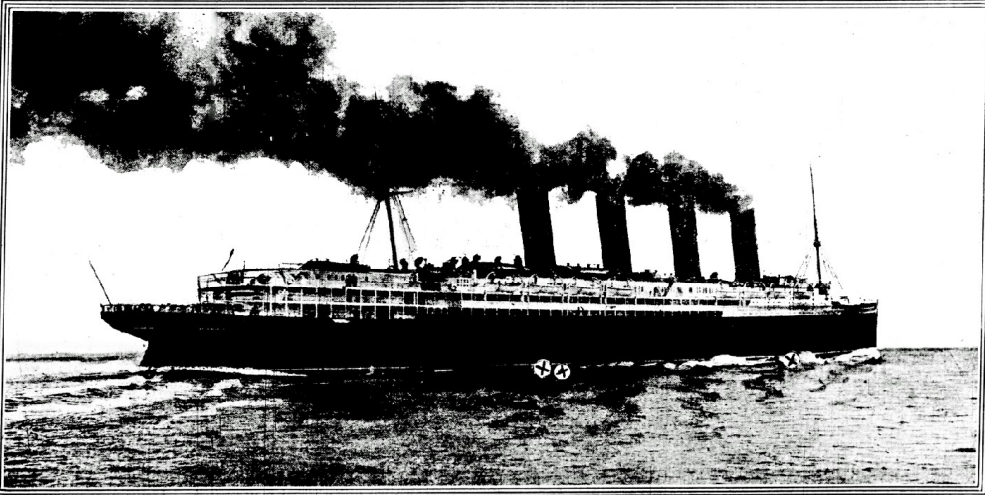
SHOCKS THE PRESIDENT
Washington Deeply Stirred by the Loss of American Lives.

BULLETINS AT WHITE HOUSE
Wilson Reads Them Closely, but Is Silent on the Nation's Course.

HINTS OF CONGRESS CALL
Loss of Lusitania Recalls Firm Tone of Our First Warning to Germany.

CAPITAL FULL OF RUMORS
Reports That Liner Was to Be Sunk Were Heard Before Actual News Came.

Special to The New York Times.
WASHINGTON, May 7. — Never since that April day, three years ago, when word came that the Titanic had gone down, has Washington been so stirred as it is tonight over the sinking of the Lusitania. The early reports told that there had been no loss of life, but the relief that these advances toward peace war in the Atlantic concern late this evening when it became known that there had been many



SOME DEAD TAKEN ASHORE
Several Hundred Survivors at Queenstown and Kinsale.

STEWARDS TELL OF DISASTER
One Torpedo Crashes Into the Doomed Liner's Bow. Another Into the Engine Room.

SHIP LISTS OVER TO PORT
Makes It Impossible to Lower Many Boats. So Hundreds Must Have Gone Down.

ATTACKED IN BROAD DAY
Passengers at Luncheon—Warning Had Been Given by Germans Before the Ship Left New York.

Only 650 Were Saved, Few Cabin Passengers
QUEENSTOWN, Saturday, May 8, 1:28 A. M.—Survivors of the Lusitania who have arrived here estimate that only about 650 of those aboard the steamer were saved.

The Lost Cunard Steamship Lusitania
X Where the First Torpedo Struck. XX Where the Second Torpedo Struck

The Zimmermann Telegram alarmed America — Germany secretly offered Mexico the return of Texas, New Mexico, and Arizona, making the German threat seem direct and immediate.

ZOOM IN

RECEIVED
October 1-8-18
Washington, State Dept.
By *Wm. A. Eckhoff, Assistant*
Date *Oct. 27, 1918*

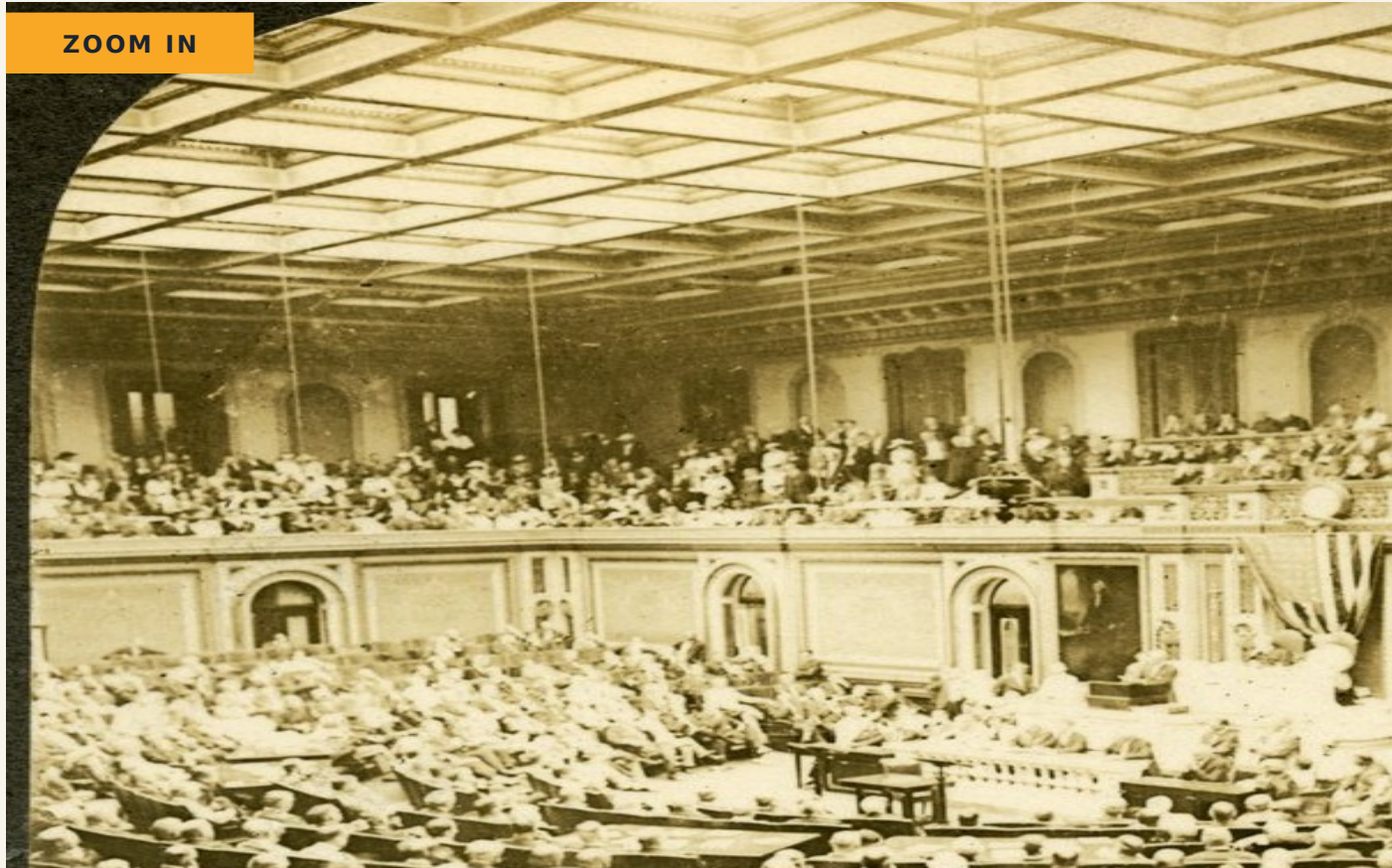
TELEGRAM RECEIVED.

FROM 2nd from London # 5747.

"We intend to begin on the first of February unrestricted submarine warfare. We shall endeavor in spite of this to keep the United States of America neutral. In the event of this not succeeding, we make Mexico a proposal of alliance on the following basis: make war together, make peace together, generous financial support and an understanding on our part that Mexico is to reconquer the lost territory in Texas, New Mexico, and Arizona. The settlement in detail is left to you. You will inform the President of the above most secretly as soon as the outbreak of war with the United States of America is certain and add the suggestion that he should, on his own initiative, ~~invite~~ ^{induce} Japan to immediate adherence and at the same time mediate between Japan and ourselves. Please call the President's attention to the fact that the ruthless employment of our submarines now offers the prospect of compelling England in a few months to make peace." Signed, ZIMMERMANN.

Democracy and dollars pulled America in — Wilson framed war as making the world “safe for democracy,” while \$2 billion in Allied loans and trade tied U.S. interests to Allied victory.

ZOOM IN



US.24 · Defense of Democracy & Economics

Read the Zimmermann Telegram itself — note its author, date, and secret purpose before judging its impact.

WHO

German Foreign Minister Arthur Zimmermann

WHEN

January 1917

WHY

Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Zimmermann Telegram

German Foreign Minister Arthur Zimmermann · January 1917

"We intend to begin on the first of February unrestricted submarine warfare. We shall endeavor in spite of this to keep the United States of America neutral. In the event of this not succeeding, we make Mexico a proposal of alliance on the following basis: make war together, make peace together, generous financial support and an understanding on our part that Mexico is to reconquer the lost territory in Texas, New Mexico, and Arizona."

[National Archives](#)

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Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.24:

American banks and industries with \$2 billion loaned to the Allies, plus war producers who gained jobs and profits.

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.24:

American civilians killed by submarine warfare, and the soldiers who would be drafted and sent to fight in Europe.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.24:

President Wilson, who asked for war, and Congress, which declared it in April 1917 after the telegram and renewed U-boat attacks.

Anchor: Zimmermann Telegram, 1917 (National Archives)

Words you need before we read

Unrestricted Submarine Warfare

En español: *Guerra Submarina Sin Restricciones*

WHAT IT MEANS

Germany's policy of attacking any ship—military or civilian—in the war zone around Britain without warning, which helped draw the United States into WWI.

Zimmermann Telegram

En español: *Telegrama Zimmermann*

WHAT IT MEANS

A 1917 secret message from Germany to Mexico proposing a military alliance against the United States, intercepted by the British and used to justify American entry into WWI.

RMS Lusitania

En español: *RMS Lusitania*

WHAT IT MEANS

British passenger ship torpedoed by a German U-boat on May 7, 1915, killing 1,198 people including 128 Americans, turning American public opinion against Germany.

Check your understanding

Evaluate the relative importance of economic interests versus idealistic goals in America's decision for war.

- A Only economic factors mattered, but this fails to account for the broader historical context when examined alongside the available primary and secondary sources and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic
- B Both factors were important: economic ties to the Allies and threatened trade provided practical motivation, while democratic ideals gave moral justification—neither alone fully explains American entry
- C Only idealism drove the decision, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era and fails to account for key developments in the broader context and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic
- D Neither economic nor idealistic factors played any role, although this view has been largely discredited by scholars when examined alongside the available primary and secondary sources

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😄 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.

US.25

Key Figures and Developments in World War I

TN STANDARD

US.25 – Identify and explain the impact of the following on World War I: Trench warfare, Use of new weapons and technology, Harlem Hellfighters, Herbert Hoover, John J. Pershing, Alvin C. York. (TCA)

I CAN

I can identify and explain the impact of trench warfare, new weapons and technology, the Harlem Hellfighters, Herbert Hoover, John J. Pershing, and Alvin C. York on World War I.

Trench warfare created a killing stalemate — trenches ran from the Channel to Switzerland, and machine guns, poison gas, artillery, aircraft, and tanks made WWI uniquely destructive.



US.25 · Trench Warfare & New Technology

Hoover fed the war, Pershing led it — Herbert Hoover ran food relief and voluntary conservation; General Pershing commanded a separate American Expeditionary Force.

KEY POINT

Hoover fed the war, Pershing led it — Herbert Hoover ran food relief and voluntary conservation; General Pershing commanded a separate American Expeditionary Force.

Black soldiers and a Tennessee hero proved their valor — the Harlem Hellfighters served 191 combat days, and Alvin C. York captured 132 Germans in the Argonne.

ZOOM IN



US.25 · Harlem Hellfighters & Alvin C. York

Read Alvin C. York's Medal of Honor citation — identify its author and moment before analysis.

WHO

U.S. War Department

WHEN

1918

WHY

Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Alvin C. York Medal of Honor Citation

U.S. War Department · 1918

"After his platoon had suffered heavy casualties and 3 other noncommissioned officers had become casualties, Corporal York assumed command. Fearlessly leading 7 men, he charged with great daring a machine gun nest which was pouring deadly and incessant fire upon his platoon. In this heroic feat the machine gun nest was taken, together with 4 officers and 128 men and several guns."

[National Archives](#)

A historian returns to three questions at the end of every reading. Use them to analyze this standard.

Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.25:

The Allied cause, strengthened by fresh American troops, Pershing's command, and Hoover's organized food supply.

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.25:

Soldiers in the trenches facing gas, machine guns, and artillery — including segregated Black units like the Harlem Hellfighters.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.25:

Military leaders like Pershing and administrators like Hoover — while soldiers such as York earned the war's highest honors.

Anchor: Alvin C. York, Medal of Honor Citation, 1919 (National Archives)

Words you need before we read

Trench Warfare

En español: *Guerra de Trincheras*

WHAT IT MEANS

A type of combat in which soldiers fight from elaborate systems of trenches, creating a stalemate where neither side could advance; characteristic of WWI's Western Front.

No Man's Land

En español: *Tierra de Nadie*

WHAT IT MEANS

The dangerous, exposed ground between opposing trenches in WWI, filled with barbed wire, shell craters, and dead bodies.

John J. Pershing

En español: *John J. Pershing*

WHAT IT MEANS

Commander of the American Expeditionary Forces (AEF) in WWI, who insisted on keeping American troops together as an independent force rather than integrating them into Allied armies.

Check your understanding

Analyze how technological innovations and individual heroism both shaped the American experience in WWI.

- A** Technology was irrelevant to the American experience, despite limited evidence supporting this interpretation, but contemporary accounts and primary sources suggest otherwise
- B** Individual heroism was unimportant in modern war, which does not reflect the consensus among historians when examined alongside the available primary and secondary sources
- C** New weapons created the brutal conditions Americans faced while individual heroes like York and the Hellfighters showed how Americans adapted and excelled despite the horrors of modern warfare
- D** Americans were not affected by new technologies, despite limited evidence supporting this interpretation, although historical sources do not support this conclusion

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😄 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.

US.26

World War I Home Front

TN STANDARD

US.26 – Analyze the political, economic, and social ramifications of World War I on the home front, including: Role played by women and minorities, Voluntary rationing, Committee on Public Information, Opposition by conscientious objectors, Schenck v. United States decision.

I CAN

I can analyze the political, economic, and social ramifications of World War I on the home front, including the role of women and minorities, voluntary rationing, the Committee on Public Information, conscientious objectors, and the Schenck v. United States decision.

Federal power expanded dramatically — the War Industries Board, Selective Service (24 million registered), and the Espionage and Sedition Acts restricted speech and prosecuted dissent.

ZOOM IN



The economy mobilized for war — Hoover’s “Meatless Mondays,” Victory Gardens, and \$21 billion in Liberty Bonds financed and fed the war effort.



US.26 · Economic Effects & Rationing

War reshaped society — women entered wartime jobs (strengthening the suffrage case) and the Great Migration brought 500,000 African Americans north for industrial work.



Read Justice Holmes in *Schenck v. United States* — note the Court's authority and moment before weighing the ruling.

WHO

Justice Oliver Wendell Holmes

WHEN

1919

WHY

Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Schenck v. United States Decision

Justice Oliver Wendell Holmes · 1919

"The question in every case is whether the words used are used in such circumstances and are of such a nature as to create a clear and present danger that they will bring about the substantive evils that Congress has a right to prevent. When a nation is at war, many things that might be said in time of peace are such a hindrance to its effort that their utterance will not be endured."

[Library of Congress](#)

A historian returns to three questions at the end of every reading. Use them to analyze this standard.

Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.26:

The federal government, which gained unprecedented control; and women and Black migrants who gained new jobs and arguments for rights.

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.26:

Anti-war activists, socialists, and German-Americans prosecuted under the Espionage and Sedition Acts and Schenck's "clear and present danger" test.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.26:

Congress and wartime agencies expanding federal power, and the Supreme Court (Holmes) upholding limits on free speech.

Anchor: Oliver Wendell Holmes, Schenck v. United States, 1919 (National Archives)

Words you need before we read

Committee on Public Information

En español: *Comité de Información Pública*

WHAT IT MEANS

A government propaganda agency created in 1917 to build support for WWI through posters, films, speeches, and censorship of anti-war messages.

Espionage and Sedition Acts

En español: *Leyes de Espionaje y Sedición*

WHAT IT MEANS

Laws passed in 1917-1918 making it illegal to interfere with the draft, criticize the government or war effort, or encourage disloyalty, severely limiting free speech during WWI.

Schenck v. United States

En español: *Schenck v. Estados Unidos*

WHAT IT MEANS

A 1919 Supreme Court case that upheld the Espionage Act, ruling that speech creating a "clear and present danger" could be restricted, even in peacetime.

Check your understanding

Analyze how the *Schenck v. United States* decision balanced national security needs with First Amendment rights.

- A** The Court fully protected free speech, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era when examined alongside the available primary and secondary sources and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic
- B** The Court declared all wartime speech restrictions unconstitutional, which does not reflect the consensus among historians and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic
- C** The case had no impact on free speech law, but the historical record tells a more complex story, which represents a common misconception about this historical period and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic
- D** The Court ruled speech creating "clear and present danger" could be restricted, upholding Schenck's conviction and establishing that First Amendment rights are not absolute during wartime emergencies

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😄 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.

US.27

Wilson's Fourteen Points and League of Nations

TN STANDARD

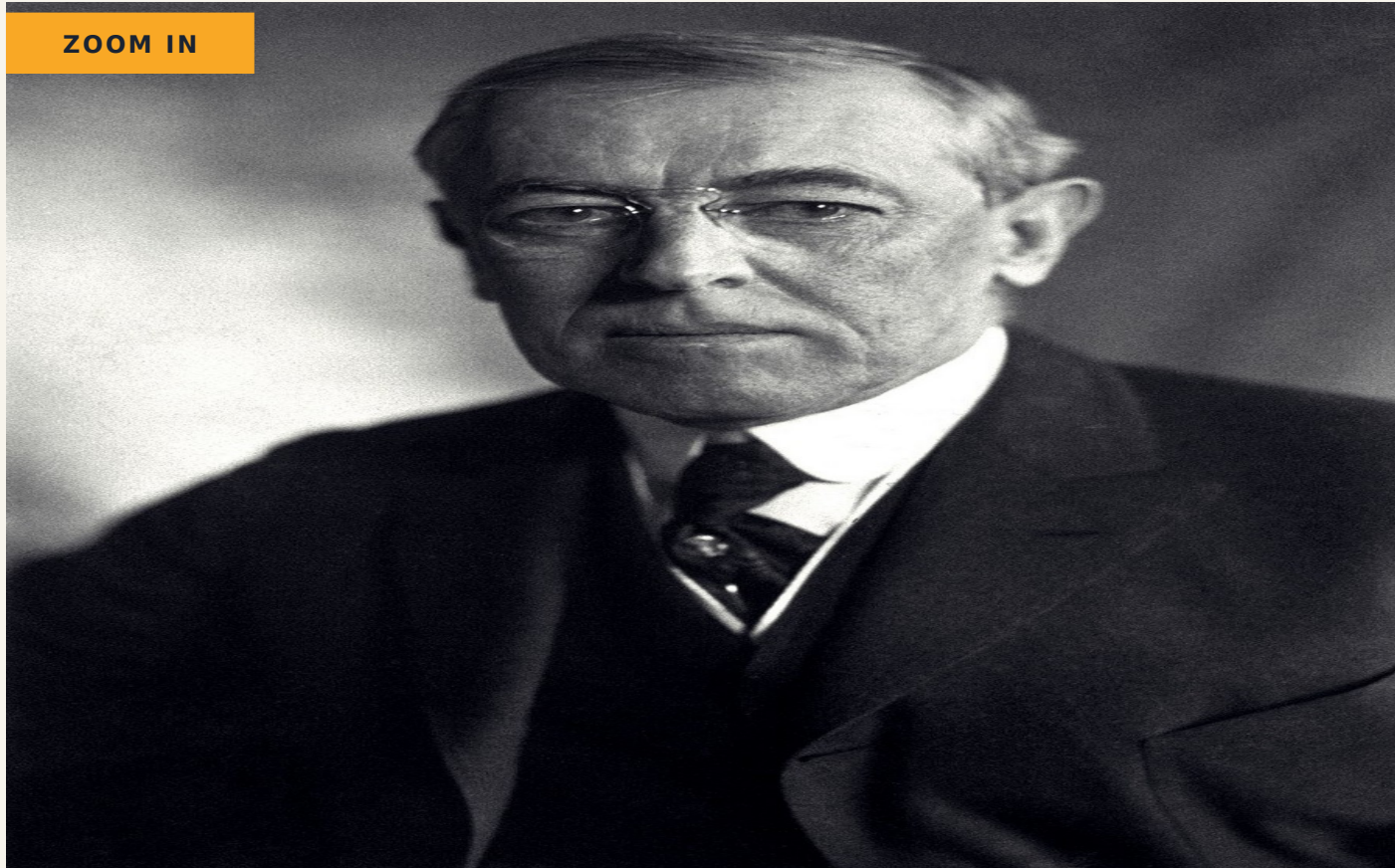
US.27 – Analyze the significance of President Woodrow Wilson's Fourteen Points, the causes and effects of the U.S. rejection of the League of Nations, and the subsequent impact on world politics.

I CAN

I can analyze the significance of President Woodrow Wilson's Fourteen Points, the causes and effects of the U.S. rejection of the League of Nations, and the subsequent impact on world politics.

Wilson offered a peace plan — his Fourteen Points (Jan. 1918) called for open diplomacy, freedom of the seas, self-determination, and a League of Nations to keep the peace.

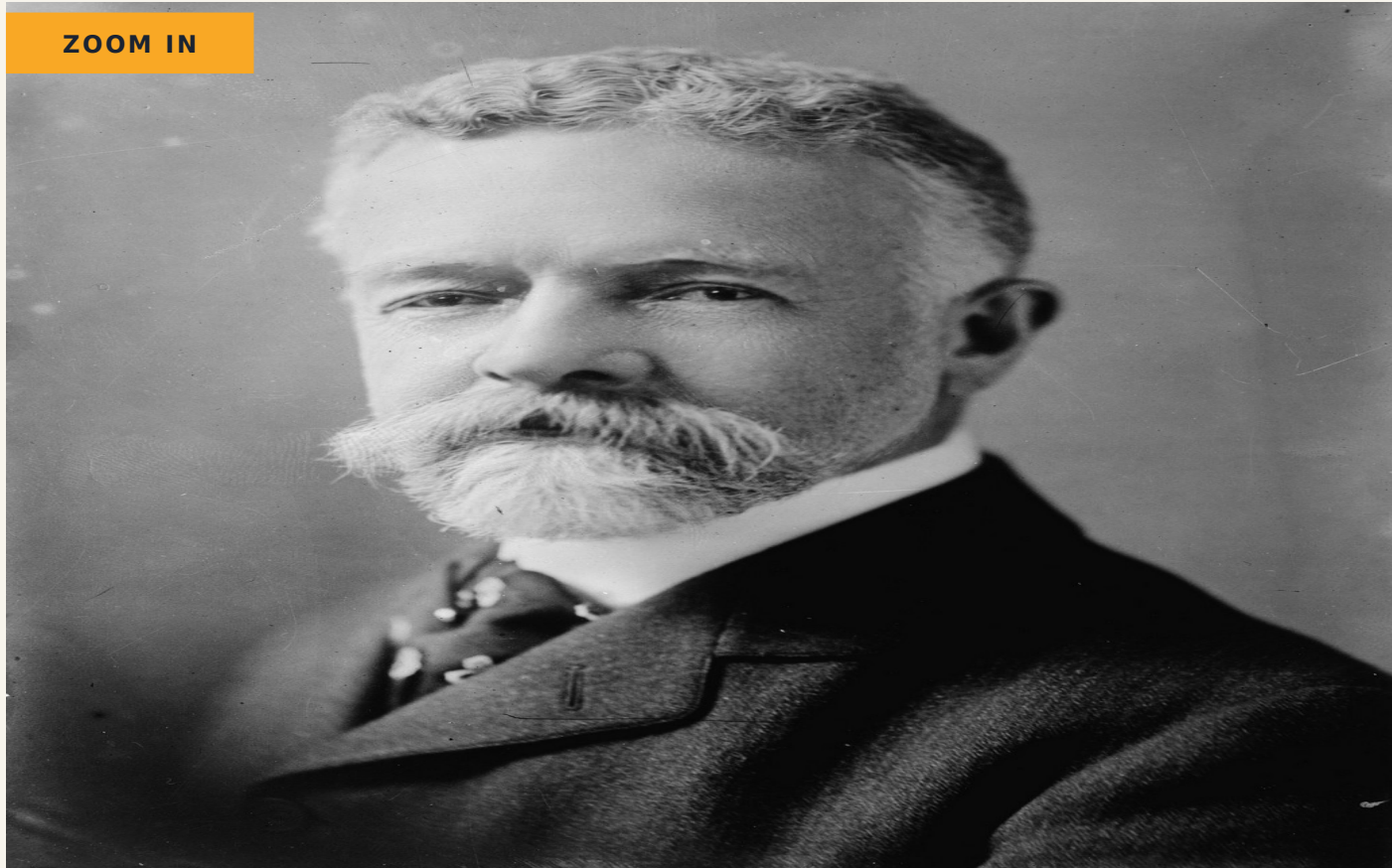
ZOOM IN



US.27 · Wilson's Fourteen Points

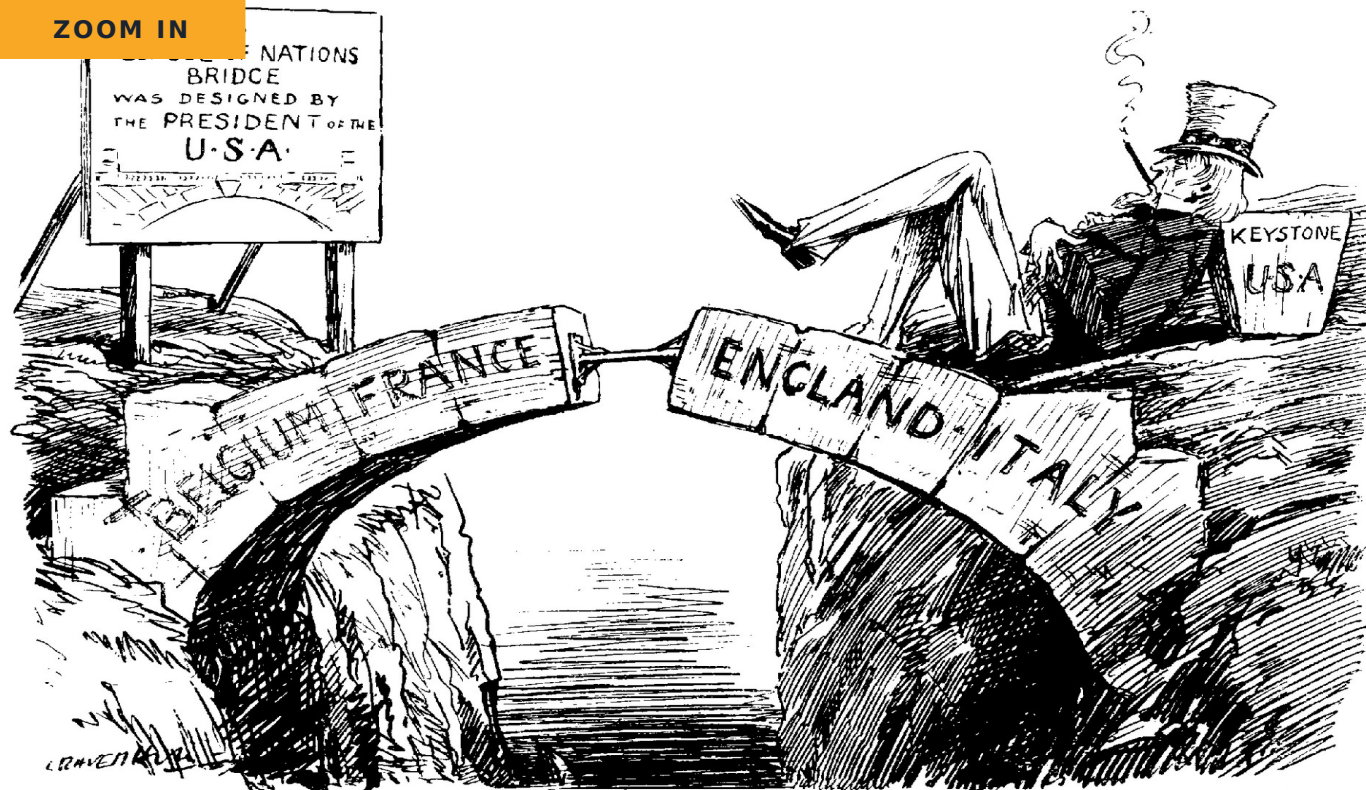
The Senate rejected the League — Lodge's Reservationists feared Article X's obligations, Irreconcilables opposed any membership, and Wilson refused to compromise.

ZOOM IN



American absence doomed the League — without U.S. power it could not stop Japan in Manchuria, Italy in Ethiopia, or Germany — helping set the stage for World War II.

ZOOM IN



THE GAP IN THE BRIDGE.

Read Wilson's Fourteen Points — identify its author, date, and purpose before judging it.

WHO

President Woodrow Wilson

WHEN

January 8, 1918

WHY

Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

The Fourteen Points

President Woodrow Wilson · January 8, 1918

"A general association of nations must be formed under specific covenants for the purpose of affording mutual guarantees of political independence and territorial integrity to great and small states alike... Open covenants of peace, openly arrived at, after which there shall be no private international understandings of any kind."

[National Archives](#)

A historian returns to three questions at the end of every reading. Use them to analyze this standard.

Who benefited?

Who gained land, wealth, power, or protection?

US.27:

Senate Reservationists and Irreconcilables who preserved American sovereignty and congressional war powers by rejecting the League.

Who bore the costs?

Who lost land, labor, freedom, or life — and who was silenced?

US.27:

Wilson, whose idealistic vision collapsed, and the world, left with a weakened League unable to prevent 1930s aggression.

Who decided?

Which people, offices, or courts held the authority?

US.27:

The U.S. Senate, which rejected the Treaty of Versailles in 1919 and 1920, and Wilson, whose refusal to compromise sealed the outcome.

Anchor: Treaty of Versailles / Fourteen Points, 1918–1919 (National Archives)

Words you need before we read

Fourteen Points

En español: *Catorce Puntos*

WHAT IT MEANS

Woodrow Wilson's 1918 peace plan emphasizing self-determination, free trade, open diplomacy, disarmament, and the creation of a League of Nations.

Treaty of Versailles

En español: *Tratado de Versalles*

WHAT IT MEANS

The 1919 peace treaty ending WWI that blamed Germany for the war, imposed massive reparations, stripped Germany of territory, and created the League of Nations.

League of Nations

En español: *Liga de Naciones*

WHAT IT MEANS

An international organization created after WWI to prevent future wars through collective security and diplomacy; the United States never joined due to Senate opposition.

Check your understanding

Evaluate whether Wilson's idealistic approach to international relations was realistic for the post-war world.

- A** Wilson's vision of collective security and self-determination was inspiring but faced practical obstacles including Senate opposition, European power politics, and the difficulty of enforcing peace without American commitment
- B** Wilson's approach was completely realistic, although historical sources do not support this conclusion and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era
- C** Idealism played no role in Wilson's thinking, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era, which represents a common misconception about this historical period, which does not align with the documented historical record
- D** The League succeeded despite American absence, although this view has been largely discredited by scholars, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era, although historical sources do not support this conclusion

Confidence: 😞 1 😊 2 😄 3 — circle where you are; your teacher routes reteach or extension.